



New Samsung Exynos SoC

Samsung has announced a more powerful Exynos processor, without built-in 5G.
<https://digit.in/nov19-25>



Google spying on employees?

Google has been accused of creating a 'surveillance tool' to monitor employees' unionizing efforts.
<https://digit.in/nov19-26>

AI are prioritised, including fairness, accountability and transparency when developing an algorithm.

The role of an AI ethicist requires certain qualifications. The person must be technologically literate and must preferably be trained in social sciences, anthropology, ethnography, psychology and other such humanistic disciplines.



The task of diminishing AI bias could be taken up by AI ethicists or specialists

RESPONSIBILITIES OF AN AI ETHICIST

AI Ethicists are typically in charge of educating employees, as well as customers, on ethical considerations surrounding AI. They could take up developing cross-functional teams that function as sounding boards that ultimately focus on the implications of AI deployments. O'Brien believes, "It is crucial to think about the diversity of teams that are building AI-enabled products".

An AI ethicist also develops a collection of policies within the company about how to use AI and related technologies. These policies could include ones that focus on model transparency to avoiding algorithmic bias and also revolving around specific applications such as predictive policing. Essentially, they are responsible for determining the overall output and performance of AI's within the prescribed ethical framework of the company.

THE NEED FOR AI ETHICISTS

The call for AI ethics specialists or AI ethicists has never been more discernible since even technology leaders are publicly acknowledging that their AI-enabled products may be flawed

and detrimental to employment, privacy and human rights. Companies are more likely to face increasing risk owing to their faulty AI ethics. Microsoft and Alphabet Inc even revealed the risks when it comes to AI in their Security and Exchange filings. Microsoft's 2018 annual report stated, "AI algorithms may be flawed. If we can enable or offer AI solutions that are controversial because of their impact on human rights, privacy, employment, or other issues, we may experience brand or reputational harm".

Google also displayed a similar stand during its recent IOK (December 2018). They were also of the opinion that AI-enabled products and services can raise ethical challenges which may ultimately negatively affect their brand and demand for their products and services.

Therefore, the need for businesses, especially large ones, to hire AI ethicists and formulate an AI review board has never been higher. Companies must develop AI audit trails and execute AI training programs. In addition to this, a Brookings Institution report also advised companies to fashion a remediation plan that can be executed if their AI technology does inflict any kind of social harm. For example, Amazon Inc. was found to have an internal algorithm under development which analysed resumes from job applicants. However, the algorithm developed a penchant for male applicants, thereby downgrading women applicants' resumes, as per news reports. Therefore, AI ethicists will become increasingly important as AI is beginning to be widely adopted across the globe and such situations can cause grave consequences for companies.

MORAL GROUNDING OR RISK MITIGATION?

Concerns from large companies employing AI in their products and

services have led to the advent of the 'AI Ethicist' job title. However, questions have been raised about whether this measure was directed towards actually solving AI ethical issues or if it is merely a business risk mitigation effort. Looking at the comments from Google and Microsoft in the last section, there is a tangible emphasis on the words 'brand' and 'reputation', which calls to question if the companies truly care about the implications of unethical AI on their customers or if they're merely worried about legal and reputation implications that ultimately soil their brand perception in customers' minds. There have been concerns that AI ethicists are just a part of a 'machine-washing' scheme, where companies are simply adopting a 'trend' to further their public image.

While the intentions of big brands may be unclear, and somewhat worrisome, they did exhibit tremendous transparency in their statements regarding AI ethics. They are worried



Amazon's automated hiring tool found to be unethical since it favoured men's resumes

about 'brand' and 'reputation' but are also working hard to avoid unethical AI behaviour, which, ultimately, benefits the end-users. AI ethicists must become visible representatives of companies and their actions and policies must have a tangible impact if they want to escape being labelled as 'machine-washing' schemes. Ultimately, creating effective AI guidelines and ensuring they are upheld is what AI ethicists must strive to do in order to minimise the implications of unethical AI on the company, and more importantly, the consumers.